CHAPTER SIX

PERSONALITY



PERSONALITY

- Personality is derived from the word "Persona"
  - Which refers to the **theatrical masks** worn by Greek actors



- **Personality** – is an individual's **unique** and **relatively consistent** patterns of **thinking**, **feeling**, and **behaving**



Cont …

- However it should **not** be confused with:

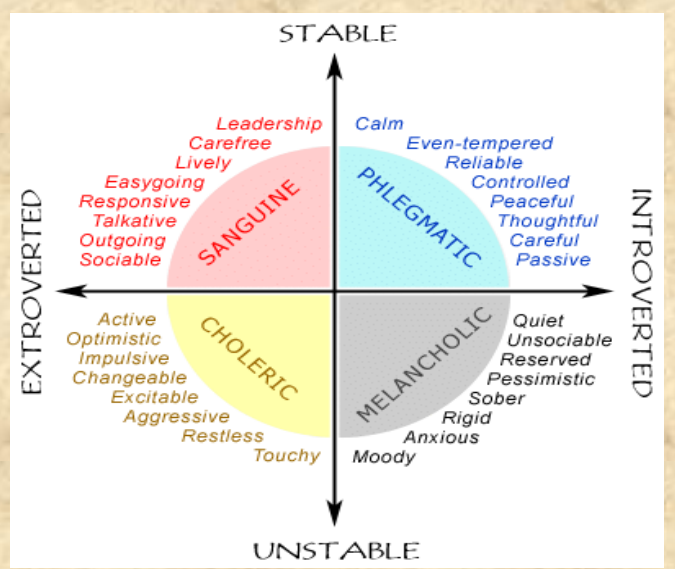
- **Character – value judgments** made about a person's moral ethical behavior OR with

- **Temperament –** an **enduring or stable characteristics** with which each person is born such as:

  - Irritability/Bad temper

    OR

  - Adaptability



Theories of Personality

- **Psychoanalytic Theory**:
  - Personality is formed within ourselves

    i.e. arising from basic ***inborn needs, drives*** and ***characteristics***
  - People are in ***constant conflict*** between their ***biological urges (drives)*** and the need to tame/ attain them
  - According to Freud's view, personality has three parts/structures : **the id, the ego**, and **the superego**

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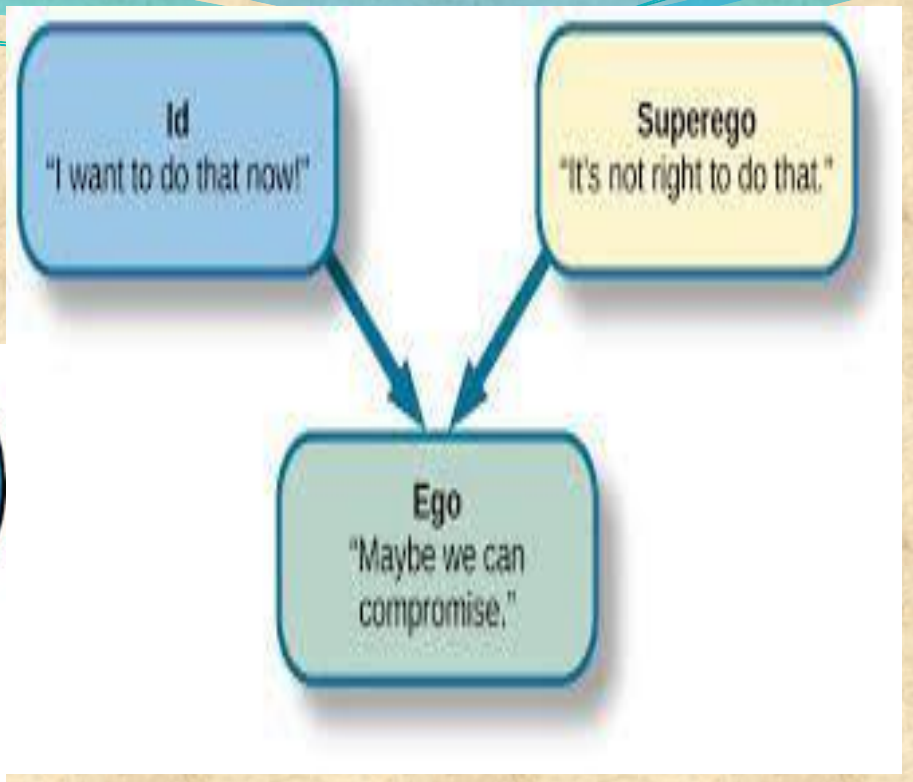
- **What is**

Id?

Ego? And

Superego?





Cont …

- **The ID**: most primitive part of personality in the infant
  - Led by ***pleasure principle/ the desire to satisfy needs***
  - Completely **unconscious amoral** part of the personality that exists at **birth**,
  - Containing all of the basic **biological drives**:
    - Hunger,
    - Thirst, Sex and
    - Aggression

Cont …

- When these needs are active the person will have an increase in physical and psychological tension
  - Freud called this **libido**
  - These **instinctual energy** comes in to conflict with the *society's standards of behavior*
  - When libidinal energy is high, it is unpleasant for the person, so the goal is to reduce libido by fulfilling the drive;

i.e. Eat when hungry, drink when thirsty, and satisfy the sex needs

Cont . . .

- **The EGO**: works on the ***reality principle***
  - Mostly conscious and is far more rational, logical and real than the id
  - Ego reduces/satisfies the need for ID without ***negative consequences***
  - Sometimes the EGO *denies the need of the ID* b/c the **consequences are painful or unpleasant**

Cont …

- Can ***repress desires that cannot*** be met in an acceptable manner

  i.e. with no negative consequence.

- **Mediator/ Executive** between id and superego,

  - because Id and superego are always in **psychic conflict**.

- **The Super ego:** works in **moral principle**
  - Develops at a preschool-aged child learns the **rules, customs**, and ***expectations of the society***
  - There are **two** parts to the superego:
    - **The ego ideal** is a kind of ***measuring device***.
      - It is the sum of all the ideal or
      - **Correct** and **acceptable** behavior that the child has learned in the society.

Cont …

- The conscience: makes people pride when they do the ***right thing*** and guilt, **OR** feel **moral anxiety** when they do the wrong thing.

- **For Freud**, our personality is the outcome of the ***continual battle for dominance among the id, the ego, and the superego***
  - This conflict is resolved by defense mechanisms

Cont …

- **Repression:** pushing or keeping threatening thoughts, emotions or feelings and thoughts from consciousness to the unconscious.



  - Characterized by motivational forgetting, doing consciously.

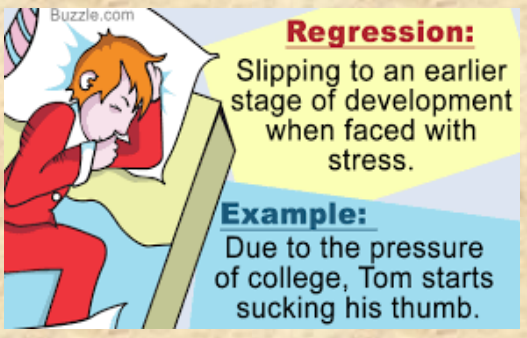
- **Denial**: is refusal to recognize or acknowledge a threatening situation.



Example: didn't fail my exam, it must be a mistake

- **Regression**: involves reverting to immature behaviors that have relieved anxiety in the past.

Example: a girl/a boy who has just entered school may go back to sucking her/his thumb or wetting the bed



Cont …

- **Rationalization**: giving socially acceptable reasons for one's inappropriate behavior.

- Finding rational explanation for sth. wrong or failed to get what you want



Example: young man who was stood up for a date says she was ugly anyways

- **Displacement**: the defense mechanism that involves expressing feelings toward a person who is less threatening than the person who is the true target of those feelings.

Example: Hating your boss but taking it out on family members.



- **Projection**: reducing anxiety by attributing unacceptable impulses to someone else.
  - Blaming someone else for one's own shortcomings.

Example: a guy sexually attracted to a neighbor perceives the neighbor as sexually attracted to him.

Cont …

- **Reaction formation**: replacing an unacceptable wish with its opposite to that of the real one.

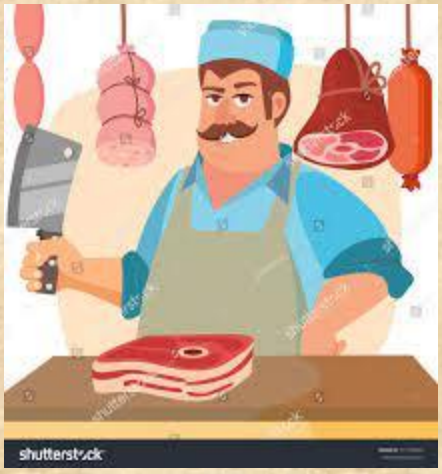
Example: a person with sexual desires ends up becoming an active proponent of a demonstration against sex provoking movies.

Cont …

- **Sublimation**: defense mechanism that involves expressing sexual or aggressive behavior through indirect, socially acceptable outlets.

Example: a person with strong feelings of aggression becomes a soldier or a butcher.





Trait Approach to personality

- **They** see personality as a combination of stable internal characteristics that people display consistently:
  - Over time and across situations.

There are **three** main assumptions:

- Personality traits are:
  - Relatively stable, and
  - Therefore are **predictable**,
  - **Over time/across situations**

Cont …

- Personality traits are relatively stable across situations, and they can explain why people act in predictable ways in many different situations.

  Example: A person who is competitive at work will probably also be competitive on the tennis court or at a party.

Cont …

- People differ in how much of a particular personality trait they possess;
  - I.e. no two people are exactly alike on all traits
  - The result is an endless variety of unique personalities

➢ There are five trait dimensions known as the **OCEAN**

- **Openness** can best be described as a person's willingness to try new things and be open to new experiences.
  - Being creative and open to new ideas
  - Indicates how open minded a person is?

Cont …

- **Conscientiousness** refers to a person's organization and motivation,
  - The tendency of people to be ***careful, hardworking, organized & dependable*** in their work & life .
  - Someone scoring low on this dimension, might always be late to important social events or borrow belongings and fail to return them or return in poor coordination.

Cont …

- **Extraversion** extent of sociability, fun-loving and out ward interaction,
  - Carl Jung believed that all people could be divided into **two** personality types:
  - **Extraverts** are outgoing and sociable, whereas
  - **Introverts** are more solitary/lonely and dislike being the center of attention





Cont …

- **Agreeableness** refers to the basic emotional style of a person,



  - Extent of agreeableness,

    soft hearted, trusting

  - Who may be easygoing, friendly and pleasant (at the high end of the scale) or

  - Grumpy/irritable, crabby and hard to get along with (at the low end).

Cont …

- **Neuroticism** refers to emotional instability or stability

  - People who are excessive worriers, over anxious and moody would high on this dimension, whereas



  - Anxious, irritable, stable/unstable
  - Those who are more even-tempered and calm could score low

The Humanistic Approach

- Emphasize people's inherent goodness and their tendency to move toward higher levels of functioning
- Instead of seeing people as controlled by:
  - The unconscious,
  - Unseen forces (psychodynamic approaches), and
  - A set of stable traits (trait approaches)

Cont …

- Carl Rogers and Abraham Maslow wanted psychology to focus on the things that make **people uniquely human,** such as:
  - Subjective emotions, and
  - The freedom to choose one's destiny
- Rogers believed that human beings are always striving to fulfill their innate capacities and capabilities and
  - To become everything that their genetic potential will allow them to be

Cont …

I.e. striving for fulfillment - **self-actualizing tendency**

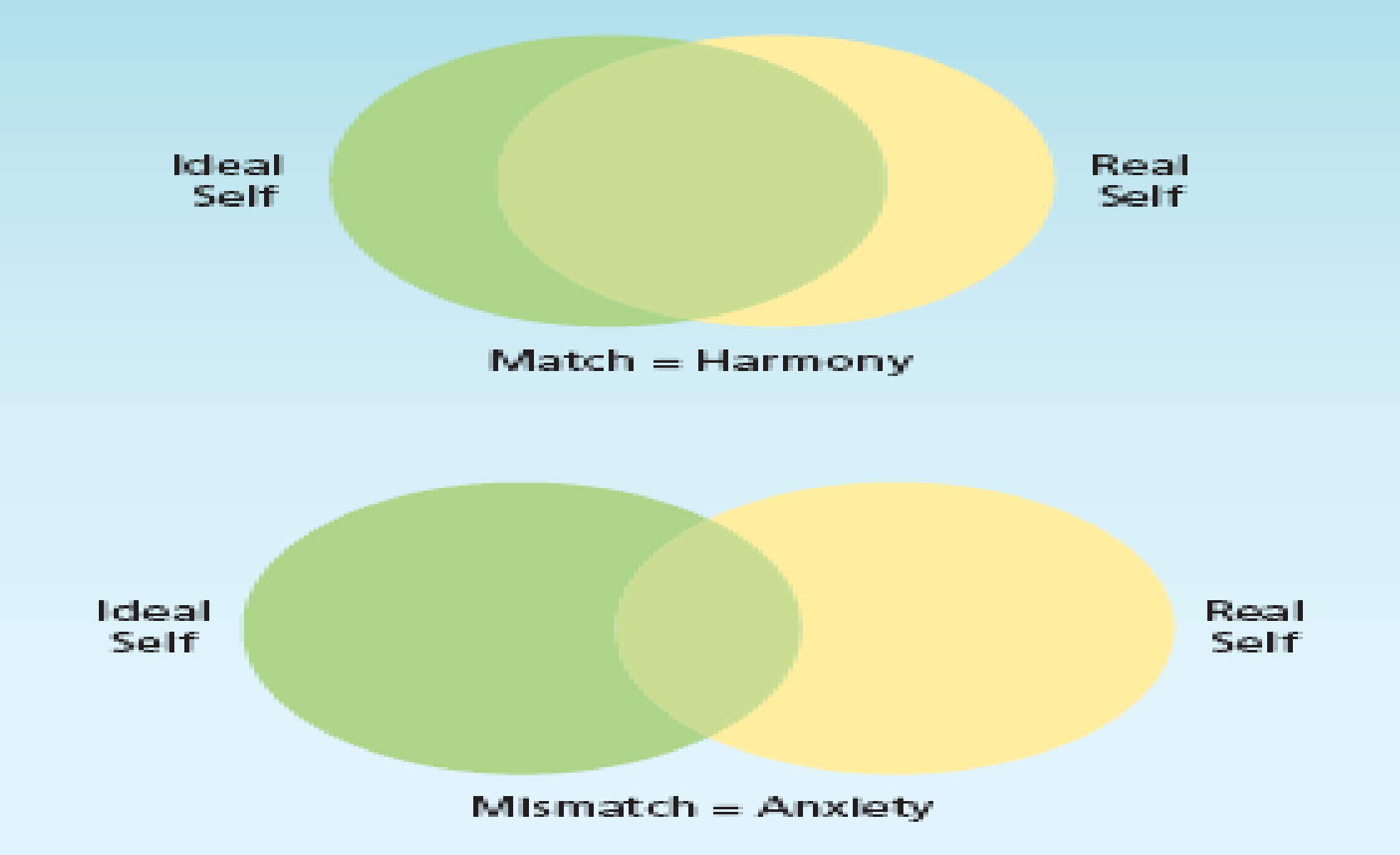
- An important tool in human **self-actualization** is the development of an **image of oneself** or the **self-concept**
- Self concept is based on what:
  - **People are told by others** and
  - How the sense of self is reflected in the words and actions of important people in one's life,

  i.e **parents, siblings, coworkers, friends, and teachers**

There are two important components

- **The real self** - one's actual perception of ***characteristics, traits, and abilities that form the basis of the striving self-actualization***
- **The ideal self -** the perception of what one should be or would like to be
  - Comes from those important, **significant others in one's life, most often the parents**
  - Rogers believed that when the real self and the ideal self are ***very close or similar*** to each other, people feel ***competent*** and ***capable***,
  - But when there is a mismatch between them, **anxiety** and **neurotic** behavior can be the result

Cont...


Ideal Self
Real Self
Match = Harmony
Ideal Self
Real Self
MIsmatch = Anxiety

Cont …

- Rogers defined *Unconditional* ***positive regard*** as:

  - Warmth, affection,
  - Love, and respect

  } that comes from our **significant** others

  i.e. parents, admired adults, friends, and teachers

- It is **vital to people's ability to cope with stress** and to **strive to achieve self-actualization**

Cont …

- ***Conditional positive regard***, which is:

  - ***Love, affection***,
  - ***Respect*** and
  - ***Warmth***

  } that depend, or seem to depend, on doing what those people want

  i.e. parents, admired adults, friends, and teachers

Cont …

- Rogers believed to ***self-actualize, there must be a match between real and ideal self***
  - i.e. to be a fully functioning person
- Fully functioning people are in touch with their:
  - **Feelings** &
  - **Abilities** and

  } can trust their **innermost urges** and **intuitions**
- To be fully functioning is a necessary step in the process of self-actualization

Cont …

- Self-actualizing qualities are being **creative**, **autonomous** and **unprejudiced**

- Those people who would be seen as having:
  - Trusted their true feelings & than just going
  - Innermost needs rather along with the crowd

Example: Albert Einstein, Mahatma Gandhi, and Eleanor Roosevelt – self actualized people